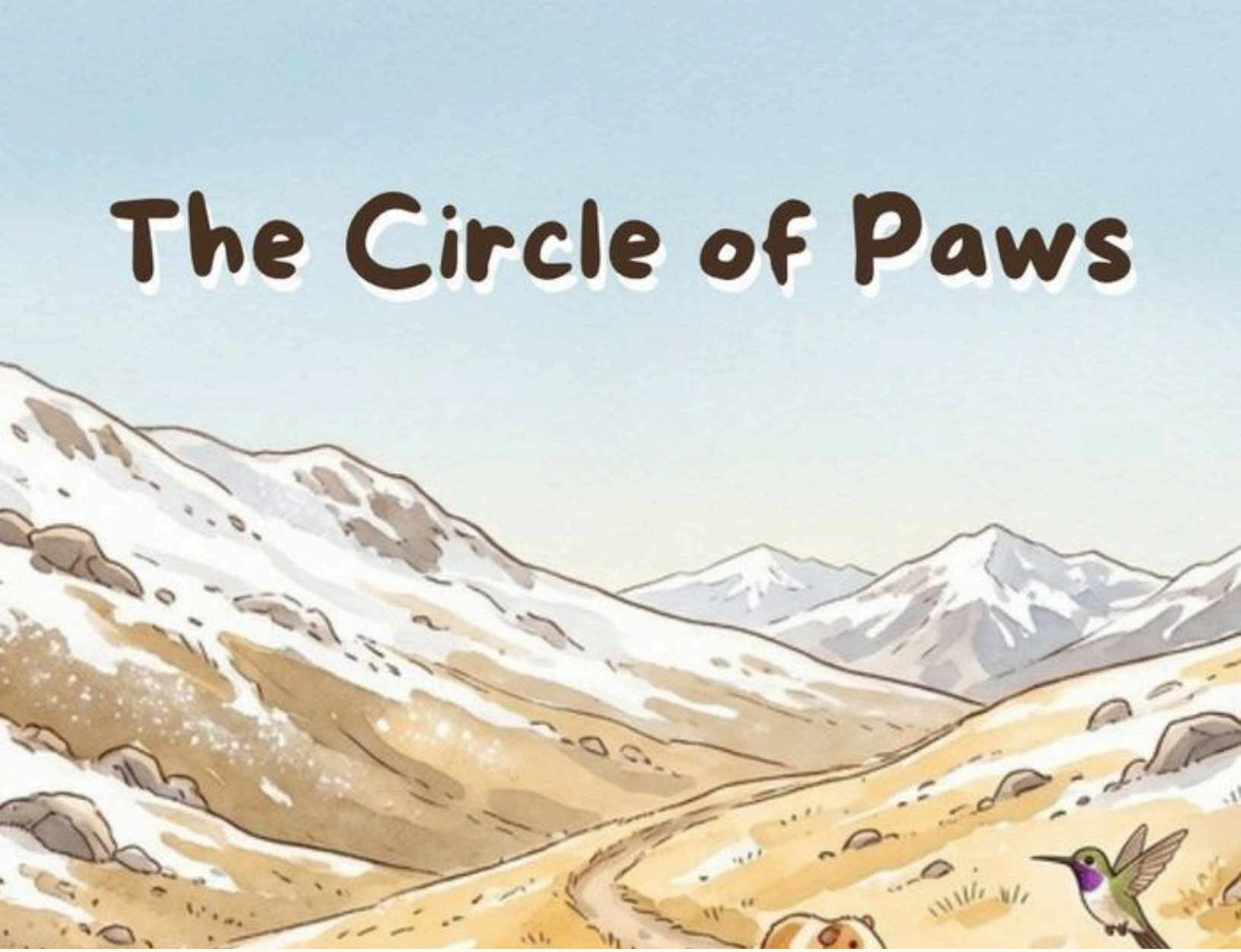


Classroom SEL pack, a week on giving and receiving, ages 3 to 7

The Circle of Paws

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Yarn circle	Sit in a circle. Hold the end, say one way you can help someone (‘I can carry the books’), and roll the yarn to a friend. Keep going until the circle is a web. Notice how…	Page 8
Day 5 Catch game	Catch game, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Belonging and Contributing, Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours

Materials

The book (or the class screen), a soft ball, a ball of yarn, small blocks or stones

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English, French, Spanish, German, Italian.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What animals do you see? Where do you think they live? What do you notice about the land? Ask: Do you like to help? Is it ever hard to let someone help you? Take a few answers. Teach the refrain: hold your neighbours' hands and sway, or roll your hands round and round. 'Paw to paw, round and round!'

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	Killa helps everyone but says 'I can do it myself!'	Why do you think Killa never lets anyone help her?	she wants to be strong, she likes helping, she doesn't want to bother anyone
4	Sami's ears droop.	How does Sami feel when Killa says no?	sad, left out, he wanted to help
5	The hailstorm wrecks Killa's burrow; she refuses help again.	What would you do if you were Killa?	ask for help, say yes to friends
6	Sami: helping is like playing catch.	What does Sami mean?	you have to let others give back, both sides throw
7	Being helped feels strange, then warm.	How did being helped feel to Killa?	strange at first, then warm, like a sweater
8	'Thank YOU, for letting us!'	Why did the viscachas thank Killa?	helping made them happy too
10	Kinti says she is too small to help.	What can Kinti give?	she can fly high and see Go further: What can you give, even if you are small?
11	Everyone gives and everyone receives.	Who helped who on the mountain?	everyone helped everyone

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don't need every stop.

Handle with care: Never count or score favours in class. The circle is about giving freely. More notes on the "For every child" page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

help

to do something that makes a job easier for someone

Do it: hold out both hands

burrow

a hole in the ground where an animal lives

Do it: cup your hands like a little cave

hail

little balls of ice that fall from the sky

Do it: tap your fingertips on the table

circle

a round shape that goes all the way around

Do it: draw a big circle in the air

give

to offer something to someone

Do it: push your open hands forward

Paw to paw, round and round!

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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Help is a circle. Let it come back around.

Paw to paw, round and round!

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



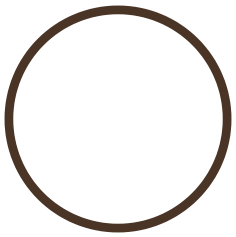
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Yarn circle

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A ball of yarn

Sit in a circle. Hold the end, say one way you can help someone (‘I can carry the books’), and roll the yarn to a friend. Keep going until the circle is a web. Notice how every child is holding a part.

Catch game

5 minutes, Pairs, Materials: A soft ball

Play catch, then try a ‘Killa round’ where one partner only throws and never catches. Ask: Was that fun? What did the other person feel?

Build a burrow together

15 minutes, Small groups, Materials: Blocks or stones

Each child brings one block to build a wall. Before adding a block, they ask the group, ‘Can you help me?’ or ‘Do you need help?’

Science and nature corner

Chinchillas live high in the Andes mountains of South America. They have some of the thickest fur of any animal and take baths in dust, not water. Vicuñas are wild relatives of the alpaca, with very fine wool; they were once almost gone and are now protected. Mountain viscachas live among the rocks, and the Andean hillstar is a hummingbird that can survive freezing nights by resting very still in rock nooks.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why do you think Killa never let anyone help her?

Look for: She wanted to do it herself, she liked being the helper.

2. How did Sami feel when she said no?

Look for: Sad, his ears drooped.

3. Why was asking for help hard for Killa?

Look for: It felt harder than lifting a stone; she wasn't used to it.

4. What did Kinti have to give?

Look for: She could fly up high and see what the others couldn't.

5. When is it hard for you to ask for help?

Look for: Any answer. Thank children for sharing.



Say it together

Paw to paw, round and round!

The big idea: Help goes around in a circle. Asking for help is brave, and letting others help you is a gift to them too.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show giving and receiving this week. Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show giving and receiving by

Name _____



I can show giving and receiving by

Name _____



I can show giving and receiving by

Name _____



I can show giving and receiving by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Belonging and Contributing	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Notes

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Science and place corner

Killa lives on the puna, a high, cold grassland across Peru, Bolivia, Chile and Argentina, mostly above 3,200 metres.



Chinchilla

You grow one hair from each tiny hole in your skin. A chinchilla grows 50 to 60. Its coat is the densest of any land mammal; only the sea otter beats it.



Vicuña

One vicuña hair is about 12 microns wide, thinner than the finest cashmere and far thinner than yours. That's how Sami stays warm on freezing nights.



Andean hillstar

To survive freezing nights, a hillstar lets its body cool to about 7 °C, close to a fridge, and sinks into a deep sleep called torpor. It was the first hummingbird proven to do it.



Mountain viscacha

They look like rabbits, but viscachas belong to the chinchilla family. Killa and her neighbours are real relatives.



Montane guinea pig

People in the Andes tamed guinea pigs thousands of years ago, from a wild ancestor like this one. A pet guinea pig's family tree starts on Killa's mountain.

The puna, high in the Andes

Killa: Real chinchillas are quick, springy jumpers, just like Killa. But a real one would be fast asleep at noon. Killa is a daytime chinchilla, just for the story.

Sami: Real vicuñas don't wear ear tassels: Sami's red tassel makes him easy to spot on every page. And a real vicuña would be out with his whole family.

Kinti: Only the male hillstar has the shiny green throat; females have a pale, speckled one. We gave Kinti the sparkle anyway. Can your child spot the change?

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-circle-of-paws

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Teach two key phrases with gestures: ‘Can you help me?’ and ‘Yes, please!’ Practise them in the burrow activity.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 3, 6 and 11). Act out ‘No, thank you’ and ‘Yes, please’ with puppets.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children make a ‘help circle’ chart for the class: who can help with what, and who might need help with what.

Handle with care

Never count or score favours in class. The circle is about giving freely.

Some children are told at home to do things alone. Honour that they are strong, and show that asking is strong too.

Ayni belongs to the Quechua and Aymara peoples. Share it as their word and practice; keep it simple and respectful, and invite Andean families to share if they wish.

Where this value comes from

In the Andes mountains of Peru and Bolivia, the Quechua and Aymara peoples have a word, ayni, for helping each other in turn: today I help you, tomorrow you help me. Families still take turns working in each other’s fields and building each other’s houses.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The Circle of Paws, a story about asking for help and letting others give. Killa the chinchilla loves helping, but she learns that saying 'yes, please' is brave and makes her friends happy too. At home, ask your child for help with something small, and let them ask you too. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Le Cercle des pattes, une histoire sur l'art de demander de l'aide et de laisser les autres donner. Killa la chinchilla adore aider, mais elle apprend que dire « oui, merci » est courageux et rend aussi ses amis heureux. À la maison, demandez à votre enfant de vous aider pour une petite chose, et laissez-le vous demander aussi. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre pedir ayuda y dejar que otros den. Killa, la chinchilla, ama ayudar, pero aprende que decir «sí, por favor» es valiente y también hace felices a sus amigos. En casa, pida a su hijo o hija ayuda con algo pequeño, y deje que también le pida ayuda a usted. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte darüber gelesen, um Hilfe zu bitten und andere geben zu lassen. Das Chinchilla Killa hilft gern, lernt aber, dass ‚Ja, bitte' mutig ist und auch die Freunde glücklich macht. Bitten Sie Ihr Kind zu Hause um Hilfe bei etwas Kleinem, und lassen Sie sich auch von ihm bitten. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sul chiedere aiuto e lasciare che gli altri diano. Killa, il cincillà, adora aiutare, ma impara che dire «sì, grazie» è coraggioso e rende felici anche gli amici. A casa, chiedete a vostro figlio o vostra figlia di aiutarvi in qualcosa di piccolo, e lasciate che anche lui o lei chieda a voi. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Giving and receiving: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Giving and receiving: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Giving and receiving: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

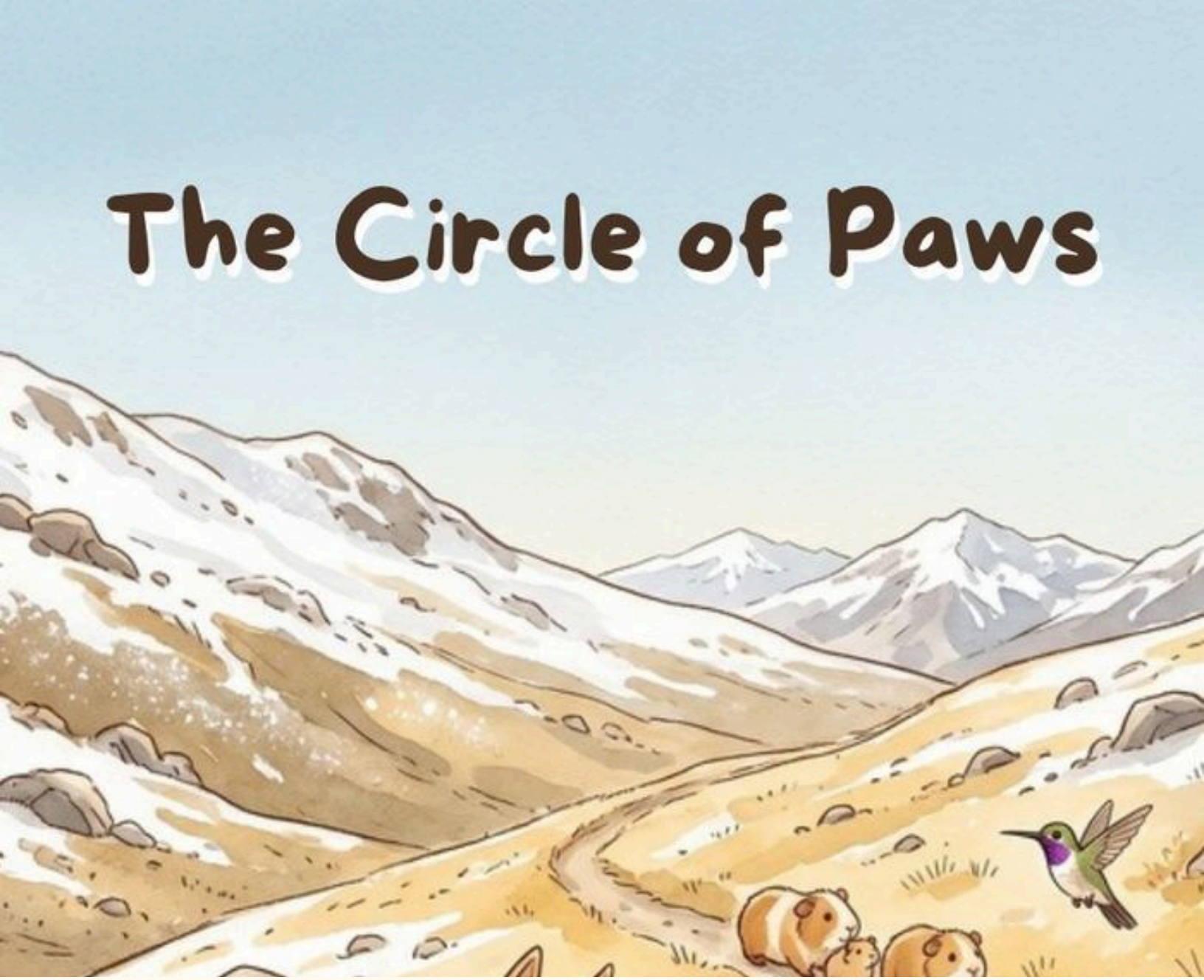
Giving and receiving: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Circle of Paws

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: giving and receiving.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Help goes around in a circle. Asking for help is brave, and letting others help you is a gift to them too.

Say it together

Paw to paw, round and round!

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
help	to do something that makes a job easier for someone	hold out both hands
burrow	a hole in the ground where an animal lives	cup your hands like a little cave
hail	little balls of ice that fall from the sky	tap your fingertips on the table
circle	a round shape that goes all the way around	draw a big circle in the air
give	to offer something to someone	push your open hands forward

A gentle note

Some children are told at home to do things alone. Honour that they are strong, and show that asking is strong too.

Ayni belongs to the Quechua and Aymara peoples. Share it as their word and practice; keep it simple and respectful, and invite Andean families to share if they wish.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Killa

Chinchilla

The fastest helper on the mountain



Sami

Vicuña

The tall, patient friend who keeps offering



Kinti

Andean hillstar

The tiny bird who thinks she's too small to help



The viscachas

Mountain viscacha

The neighbours on the sunny rocks



The guinea-pig family

Montane guinea pig

The little family with big hearts

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How did they feel?

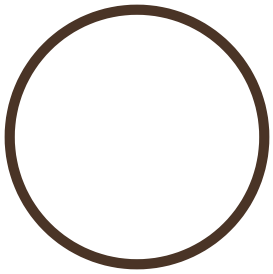
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Killa helps everyone but says ‘I can do it myself!’

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

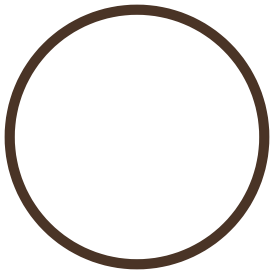


Moment 2

Being helped feels strange, then warm.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

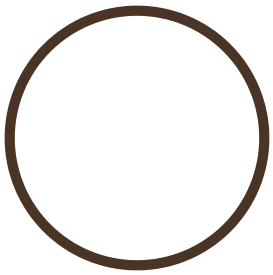


Moment 3

Everyone gives and everyone receives.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

help to do something that makes a job easier for someone

help help

burrow a hole in the ground where an animal lives

burrow burrow

hail little balls of ice that fall from the sky

hail hail

Killa the hero of the story

Killa Killa

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Killa showed giving and receiving. Draw a time when you showed giving and receiving too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Catch game

You need: A soft ball

Play catch, then try a ‘Killa round’ where one partner only throws and never catches. Ask: Was that fun? What did the other person feel?

Weigh the heroes

Find a loonie, a can of soup and a loaf of bread. Which hero weighs the same as each?

The fridge test

A hand in the fridge for three seconds. Brrr! That's how cold a sleeping hillstar gets.

Paper-tree peel

Wrap ten sheets of tissue round a tube, then peel one: a queñua losing an old coat.

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Circle of Paws are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Killa

Chinchilla

You grow one hair from each tiny hole in your skin. A chinchilla grows 50 to 60. Its coat is the densest of any land mammal; only the sea otter beats it.



Sami

Vicuña

One vicuña hair is about 12 microns wide, thinner than the finest cashmere and far thinner than yours. That's how Sami stays warm on freezing nights.



Kinti

Andean hillstar

To survive freezing nights, a hillstar lets its body cool to about 7 °C, close to a fridge, and sinks into a deep sleep called torpor. It was the first hummingbird proven to do it.



The viscachas

Mountain viscacha

They look like rabbits, but viscachas belong to the chinchilla family. Killa and her neighbours are real relatives.

Story or real?

Real chinchillas are quick, springy jumpers, just like Killa. But a real one would be fast asleep at noon. Killa is a daytime chinchilla, just for the story.

Where they really live

Killa lives on the puna, a high, cold grassland across Peru, Bolivia, Chile and Argentina, mostly above 3,200 metres.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-circle-of-paws

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What animals do you see? Where do you think they live? What do you notice about the land?

The Circle of Paws, talk card 1

Why do you think Killa never let anyone help her?

The Circle of Paws, talk card 2

How did Sami feel when she said no?

The Circle of Paws, talk card 3

Why was asking for help hard for Killa?

The Circle of Paws, talk card 4

What did Kinti have to give?

The Circle of Paws, talk card 5

When is it hard for you to ask for help?

The Circle of Paws, talk card 6

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Giving and receiving hero

This is to say that

_____

showed giving and receiving, just like Killa.

Paw to paw, round and round!

_____ Signed

_____ Date

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